

1. sqlite-utils 4.0rc2, mostly written by Claude Fable (for about \$149.25)

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-05T01:00:48+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/5/sqlite-utils-fable/#atom-everything>

I wrote about the sqlite-utils 4.0rc1 release a couple of weeks ago. Since we only have Claude Fable on our Max subscriptions for a few more days, I decided to see if it could help me get to a 4.0 stable release that I felt truly comfortable about, since I try to keep to SemVer and like my incompatible major versions to be as rare as possible. I started with this prompt, in Claude Code for web on my iPhone: Final review before shipping a stable 4.0 release - very important to spot any last minute things that would be a breaking change if we fix them later Here's that initial report it created for me. There were some significant problems that I hadn't myself encountered yet - 5 that Fable categorized as "release blockers". Here's the worst of the bunch: 1. delete_where() never commits and poisons the connection (data loss) Table.delete_where() (sqlite_utils/db.py:2948) runs its DELETE via a bare self.db.execute() with no atomic() wrapper ? compare Table.delete() at db.py:2944 , which wraps correctly. The connection is left in_transaction=True , so every subsequent atomic() call takes the savepoint branch (db.py:430-440) and never commits either. Reproduced end-to-end: db = sqli...

2. sqlite-utils 4.0rc2

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-05T00:47:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/5/sqlite-utils/#atom-everything>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.0rc2 See sqlite-utils 4.0rc2, mostly written by Claude Fable (for about \$149.25) .

3. Building a World Map with only 500 bytes

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-04T23:09:02+00:00

Link:

<https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/4/building-a-world-map-with-only-500-bytes/#atom-everything>

Building a World Map with only 500 bytes Iwo Kadziela (assisted by Codex) figured out a way to generate a credible ASCII world map using 445 bytes of data: The key trick is to use deflate compression, which is then wired together using this neat snippet of JavaScript. I didn't know you could use fetch() with data: URIs like this:

```
fetch('data:;base64,1ZpLsgIxCEXnrM...==').then( r => r.body.pipeThrough(new DecompressionStream('deflate-raw')) ).then( s => new Response(s).text() ).then( t => b.innerHTML = ' ' + t )
```

Via Hacker News Tags: ascii-art , data-urls , javascript

4. Day One Journal

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-04T21:02:43Z

Link: <https://dayoneapp.com/blog/introducing-daily-chat/>

My thanks to Day One Journal for once again sponsoring Daring Fireball. Day One first launched in 2011 and has been the stalwart of journaling apps on Mac and iOS ever since. Day One's apps exhibit a commitment to technical and design excellence, and, more importantly, everything they do is deeply informed by the intense personal nature of keeping a journal. (Or journals ? Day One lets you create as many separate journals as you want.) The Day One Mac app is Mac-assed and the iPhone and iPad apps are, well, iOS-assed. Fast, familiar, consistent, and intuitive. Day One recognizes that many people struggle with journalling not because they can't write, but because they don't know how to begin or what a 'good' journal entry about their day looks like. That's why they built Daily Chat, a guided reflection experience that helps you talk through your day, organize your thoughts, and shape them into a journal entry. Early testers commented: ' Day One's new Daily Chat is a true game changer for my daily journaling. The AI-powered chat makes capturing thoughts effortless and inspires creativity like never before. Writing my diary has never been this intuitive and fun! ' Try it for yourself...

5. From the DF Archive: ?Electron and the Decline of Native Apps?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-04T19:28:45Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2018/12/electron_and_the_decline_of_native_apps

Yours truly, back in 2018: I don?t share the depth of their pessimism regarding native apps, but Electron is without question a scourge. I think the Mac will prove more resilient than Windows, because the Mac is the platform that attracts people who care. But I worry. In some ways, the worst thing that ever happened to the Mac is that it got so much more popular a decade ago. In theory, that should have been nothing but good news for the platform ? more users means more attention from developers. The more Mac users there are, the more Mac apps we should see. The problem is, the users who really care about good native apps ? users who know HIG violations when they see them, who care about performance, who care about Mac apps being right ? were mostly already on the Mac. A lot of newer Mac users either don?t know or don?t care about what makes for a good Mac app. This eight-year-old piece holds up well. My concern was justified, but so too was my lack of defeatist pessimism. Truly native, idiomatically correct Mac-assed Mac apps are resurgent. Electron and its brethren non-native frameworks have not receded, but they haven?t gained further ground. For every Claude (Electron) there?s...

6. Fantastical 4.1.15 Adds Calendar Mirroring

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-04T16:57:22Z

Link: <https://flexibits.com/blog/2026/06/double-booked-never-heard-of-it-meet-calendar-mirroring-in-fantastical/>

Flexibits: Calendar Mirroring allows you to connect two separate calendars (like work and personal) so that events from one automatically show up on the other. The best part? No event information is sent to Flexibits servers or saved outside of your device. You can choose to show full event details or just block the time out as a mysterious, professional ?Busy?. Your coworkers don?t need to know you?re getting a root canal, they just need to know you?re unavailable. In Flexibits?s example scenario, the idea is that you have a personal calendar with important events that you want to mirror to your work calendar, to block the times for those events off ? and you might just want them marked as ?Busy? on your work calendar, rather than revealing the actual details. I?ve been using this feature in beta for a few months and love it, even though my use case is seemingly simple. For recording episodes of Dithering , Ben Thompson and I have a shared Microsoft 365 calendar. (You can guess which of the two of us set that up by that fact.) Fantastical has long had terrific built-in support for Microsoft 365 accounts. So for me, those events have always just shown up in Fantastical. For me. Th...

7. Better Models: Worse Tools

Source: Armin Ronacher?s Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-07-04T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/7/4/better-models-worse-tools/>

A very strange Pi issue sent me down a rabbit hole over the last two days. The short version is that newer Claude models sometimes call Pi?s edit tool with extra, invented fields in the nested edits[] array. And not Haiku or some small model: Opus 4.8. The edit itself is usually correct but the arguments do not match the schema as the model invents made-up keys and Pi thus rejects the tool call and asks to try again. That alone is not too surprising as models emit malformed tool calls sometimes. Particularly small ones. What surprised me is that this is getting worse with newer Anthropic models as both Opus 4.8 and Sonnet 5 show it but none of the older models. In other words, the SOTA models of the family are worse at this specific tool schema than their older siblings. In case you are curious about Fable: I intentionally did not test it because I was not sure if the classifiers they are running might downgrade me to Opus silently. Tool Calls Are Text If you have not spent too much time looking at LLM tool calling internals, the important thing to understand is that tool calls are not magic and use some rather crude in-band signalling. The model receives a transcript, a system pr...

8. This Week in Package Management: 4 July 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-04T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/04/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week seven of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases Hex 2.5.0 adds organisation-defined dependency policies: an organisation publishes a named policy through its repository, a project opts in via `HEX_POLICY` or the `:hex` block in `mix.exs` , and resolution then filters out versions that carry an advisory above a given severity, are retired for listed reasons, or are newer than a release-age threshold. Conan 2.30.0 adds SPDX expression support to its SBOM generation, a `conf~` unset operator, and IntelCC support in the Meson, Autotools and Premake toolchains. uv 0.11.25 hardens tar handling against parser differentials via an updated `astral-tokio-tar` , so uv may now reject malformed source distributions it previously accepted, and writes a full lockfile into tool receipts. 0.11.26 followed with resolver performance work reusing state across PubGrub iterations. pixi 0.72.0 adds inline package manifests, so a git dependency without a Pixi Build manifest of its own can have build backend metadata set directly in the consuming project's dependencies table. mise 2026.7.0 adds `mise install --monorepo` with a...

9. Reading List 07/04/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 04 Jul 2026 12:03:22 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-070426>

Households without homeowners insurance, crackdowns on AI chip smuggling, Japan's two electrical frequencies, Meta's AI compute business, and more.

10. Combined 1D and 2D Barcodes

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sat, 04 Jul 2026 11:34:57 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/combined-1d-and-2d-barcodes/>

This was a little idea gnawing at the back of my brain. The humble barcode has been in use since the 1970s. In the next few years it will likely be replaced with a 2D QR Code. I couldn't find anyone who'd made a QR code with an embedded UPC - so I decided to make one. If you move your phone close to the code (so it can't see the squares in the corners) it should read the number in the 1D?

11. What buffer size (OpenSSH) ssh seems to use for streaming output

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-07-04T23:28:10Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/OpenSSHStdoutIOSize>

Suppose that you're generating and transferring a file over ssh, for example to create a tar archive of something on a remote server and save it locally: `ssh [...] rem-server 'cd /var/log && tar -cf - .' >/backup/file.tar` If you're experiencing IO problems in this backup process , an interesting question is what buffer size ssh uses for its writes, perhaps because you'd like to make a few large writes to disk (for example, at the natural 128 KByte block size for your ZFS filesystems , even when you're writing over NFS) instead of a bunch of smaller ones. The ssh manual page doesn't document anything about this, and there's no options to control it in either ssh or `ssh_config(5)` . On Linux, running over TCP from a remote machine, the answer appears to be that ssh will normally do 32 KByte writes (or 64 KByte writes under some circumstances, possibly if the network is fast enough). It's possible ssh will write smaller buffers if the remote command generating the output can't keep up at full network bandwidth, and in general I suspect that there are a lot of things that can change this. If this is important to you (and I'm not convinced it's important to us), you need to re-buffer th...

12. megawatts by microwave

Source: computers are bad | Published: 04 Jul 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-07-04-microwave-and-power.html>

In 1914 the Department of the Interior, through the Bureau of Reclamation, investigated the possibilities of developing the Columbia River. Thousands of arid but potentially fertile acres needed only water to become the Imperial Valley of the Northwest. Locked in the mountain ranges were valuable ores awaiting electricity to turn them into needed metals. Two years later the State engineer of Oregon urged the development of the Bonneville site as a national-defense measure: he saw in the proposed power project a source of fertilizer in time of peace and

nitrate in time of war. The dam also would completely drown out the Cascade Rapids and extend slack-water navigation some 40 miles eastward to The Dalles. The Rivers and Harbors Act of 1925 directed the Secretary of War, through the Corps of Engineers, United States Army, to prepare and submit to the Congress an estimate of the cost of surveys, examinations, and investigations of all navigable streams and their tributaries where power development appeared feasible. (Q1) It is difficult to succinctly explain why, exactly, the United States Army has spent much of its history involved in the construction of dams. It is partly an accid...